

⇒ What is E-commerce?

~~Lecture~~

Lecture-2

20.07.2020

Ans! E-commerce (Electronic Commerce) is the use of ^{the} internet, the web, and mobile platforms to conduct business through digitally enabled commercial transactions between and among organization and individuals.

⇒ Difference between E-commerce & E-business

Feature	E-Commerce	E-Business
1. Core Meaning	Buying and selling goods for or services online.	Digitally managing all internal and external company operations
2. Boundary Reached	Reaches outside the comp. to connect with customers and suppliers.	Stays inside the company to run internal systems and daily work.
3. Exchange of value	Always involves money or financial transactions.	Does not require a financial exchange or money transfer
4. Scope	A narrower concept (it is a subset of e-business)	A broader concept (it encompasses e-commerce entirely)
5. Main target Audience	Connects with external buyers and sellers directly.	Connects internal employees, departments and operations
6. Primary Goal	Focused on revenue generation and online sales	Focused on improving operational efficiency and workflow.

7. Technology Used	Uses the public internet, web, and mobile platforms	Uses internal work networks, intranets, Enterprise system (ERP)
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Q. Why Study E-commerce?

⇒ Technological Shift: E-commerce technology is fundamentally different and significantly more powerful than any commercial technology that preceded it.

Commercial Transformation: It introduces structural changes to how commerce operates globally, altering traditional retail and supply models.

Q. Characteristics of Traditional Commerce?

To understand why E-commerce is revolutionary, the points below contrast it with the key features that defined Traditional commerce:

⇒ Consumers as Passive Targets: Consumers are treated as passive ~~income~~ recipients of marketing messages and mass products pushed by sellers without much direct interaction or feedback. Example: Watching a billboard on a highway — anyone absorb the message as a spectator without any way to click, question or interact on the spot.

⇒ Mass-Marketing Driven: Marketing relies heavily on ~~board~~ mass-media broadcasting. Example: Printing a flyer for a local bakery and distributing it to thousands of households without the info^{of} whether residents buy baked goods or not.

⇒ Sales-Force Driven: Operations depend heavily on physical sales staff to interact with customers. Example: Buying a suit at a physical shop where salesman talks to buyer in person and convinces him to buy that product.

⇒ Fixed Prices: Prices are predetermined by merchants with limited dynamic adjustments. Example: Buying shoes in a shop with 500 BDT price tag that buyer cannot bargain or negotiate lower.

⇒ Information Asymmetry: Merchants possess significantly more information about product quality, true cost and availability than consumers do. Example: Buying a used car where the dealer knows the engine has hidden problem but buyer does not.

Eight Unique Features of E-Commerce Technology

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1. Ubiquity: Technology is available everywhere, anytime, creating a "market space" that replaces physical location constraints.
E-Commerce is accessible everywhere at all time. ~~Consumer~~ Consumer can browse online stores 24 hours a day from their home, workplace or mobile phone without visiting physical shop.
2. Global Reach: Technology reaches across national boundaries to connect with customer.
E-Commerce technology breaks down geographic barriers. A merchant can sell goods or services to ~~by~~ buyers in different ~~countries~~ countries like local customer.
3. Universal Standards: there is ~~no~~ one uniform set of internet standards shared globally across platforms.
E-Commerce ~~stands~~ system runs on a single set of shared technology standards defined by the internet. Because systems worldwide use identical technical rules, different software, payment gateways,

4. Information Richness: Detailed, multimedia-rich information combining text, audio and video is delivered to the user.

E-commerce offers an engaging shopping environment by combining images, text descriptions, video demonstrations and audio. This helps consumers to evaluate the quality of that product.

5. Interactivity: Technology enables two-way communication between buyers and sellers.

E-Commerce platforms allow active user engagement. Consumers can reach for options, ask questions via live chatbots, leave product ratings and feedback.

6. Information Density: The total amount and quality of information available to all market participants increases rapidly while costs decline.

E-Commerce makes market information vast, accurate and cheap to access. Buyers can easily perform real-time price comparisons with minimal effort.

7. Personalization and Customization: Messages and products can be adjusted according to individual user preferences and behavior.

Online platforms can dynamically adapt marketing content and recommendations to match an individual's personal search history and purchase records. Sellers can also offer options to customers.

8. Social Technology: Technology enables user-generated content and social network sharing.

E-Commerce encourages consumers to create their own content, such as unboxing videos, photo reviews etc. Users can share experience and ^{can} give ratings also.